



How Does a Project Get Late?

Arguably, the most important non-renewable resource is time. But how much of it should you spend at the project or contributor level to reap the benefits of good time management? Unless you have a cost-effective solution, which is free from licence restrictions, you are defeating the very purpose of managing time.

*H*ow does a project get late? This is not a trick question. It is attributed to Frederic Brooks, author of the famous book, *The Mythical Man-month*. The answer appears towards the end of this piece and if you have observed projects getting late (haven't we all!) the answer will not come as a revelation to you. This article is more about how a young project leader learns the value of time management than the time management tools we briefly discuss anyway. The treatment is deliberate; after all, a tool is only as good as the skill of the craftsman.

Disclaimer: Any resemblance to real characters or situations is purely coincidental and unintentional. The choice of desktop environments and applications mentioned is not meant to be prejudicial in any way. The situations are contrived for the sole purpose of effective communication but are based on those in the real world. Deploying a time-tracking program is an elaborate exercise that is more about handling human emotions and resistance to change than just deploying computer-based tools. Finally, YMMV or, your mileage may vary.